

ALONE FOR EIGHTEEN YEARS.

In a recent number of the *San Francisco Call* an account is given of an Indian woman who was accidentally abandoned on San Nicolas Island, off the coast of Southern California, and spent eighteen years alone there before she was rescued. The fact of her existence was discovered by a man who went from the mainland to hunt for otters, and who found footprints sunk deeply in the ground. He was unable to follow up these indications till nearly three years, when one of a party who accompanied him came suddenly upon the object of their search. She was in a small circular enclosure made of brushwood, about five feet high, and six feet in diameter, with a small opening on one side. She was clothed with a garment made of skins of the shag, a species of duck that can neither walk nor fly. This garment reached almost to her ankles when she stood erect. She was sitting cross-legged, skinning sealblubber with a rude knife made of a piece of hoop iron driven into a piece of wood. There was no covering on her head, except a thick matted mass of hair, of yellowish-brown colour, probably owing to exposure to the sun and the weather; it was short, as if the ends had rotted off. There were

colour, probably owing to exposure to the sun and the weather; it was short, as if the ends had rotted off. There were some wild dogs on the island, a few of which kept near her, and seemed to regard her as a mistress. She had lived on a plant resembling cabbage, called by Californians *palo-santo*, and a root known by the name of *corcomite*, also blubber of the various kinds of seals, &c. She had a rude apparatus for catching shellfish, and strong fishing lines made of seal sinews, which seemed to indicate that she fished in the ocean. The expression of her face was pleasing, her features were regular, her complexion much fairer, and her form more symmetrical than that of the Indian women on the adjoining mainland. Some suspect that she belonged to a tribe much further north. She could not understand anything said to her in any of the Indian dialects of South California, but she had a wonderful capacity for conversing by signs. She retained all her teeth, but they were worn low, supposed to be due to her chewing tough and hard articles of food. Her age appeared to be about 50 years. She bowed to all

hard articles of food. Her age appeared to be about 50 years. She bowed to all who came near her, greeting them with a smile. She freely accompanied her discoverers to their vessel. She showed singular dexterity in making water-vessels from grass and asphaltum, a substance which is plentiful both on the island and the mainland. She seemed to recognise various appliances of civilization. She died about seven weeks after reaching the mainland, partly from the effects of a fall, and partly from dysentery, brought on by eating fruits and vegetables. Padre Gonzalez, the Superior of the Mission of Santa Barbara, has sent her dress of shagskins, her basket and implements, to Rome, to the Museum of the Propaganda
